Marketing funnel & channel efficiency

FY24 – FY25

Paulo Muzyczuk

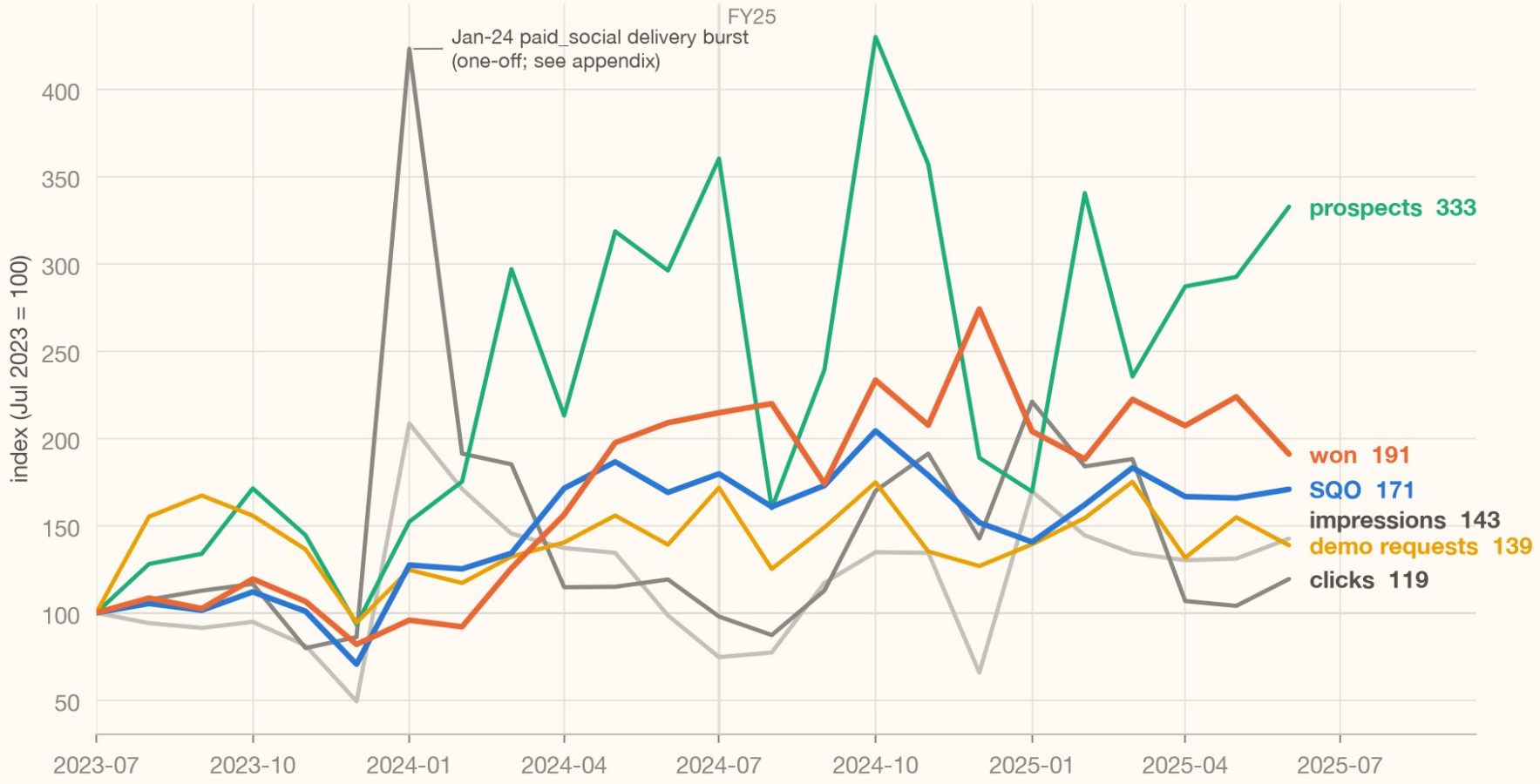
7 August 2026

Executive summary

- **FY25 growth was conversion-led, not traffic-led: attributed SQOs +35% on flat-to-declining trustworthy traffic**
- **Efficiency fell as spend scaled: branded search cost/SQO doubled on ~3× budget**
- **Roadmap: incrementality via geo-holdout on branded search, MMM for ongoing allocation**

FY25 growth was conversion-led, not traffic-led

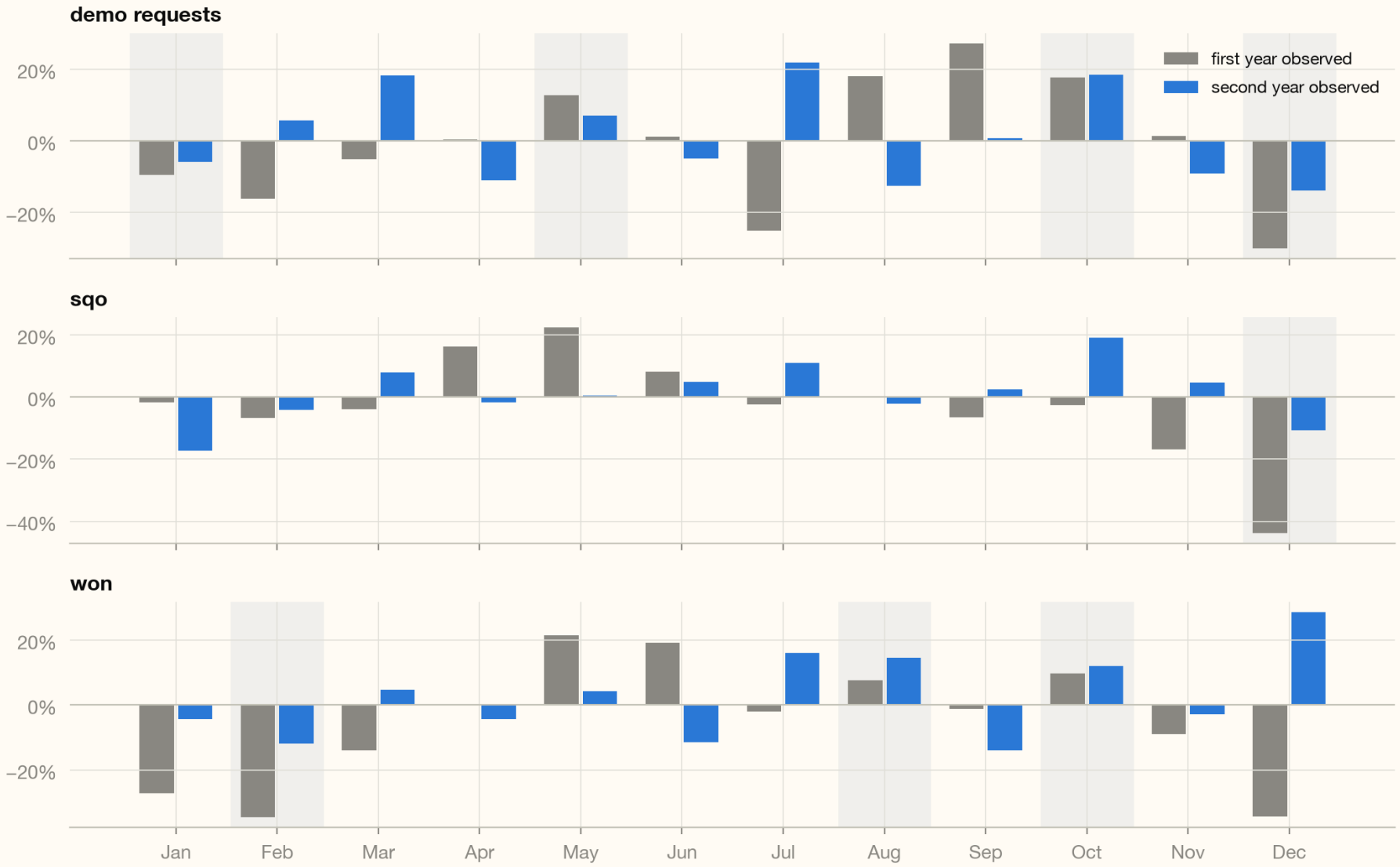
attributed SQOs +35% on flat-to-declining trustworthy traffic



- the rate shift is broad-based (8 of 10 programs)
- its cause is not determinable using the available data
- sales-side or attribution change are plausible candidates

Seasonality looks straightforward and plannable

December dips, October lifts — direction repeats, amplitude doesn't



Patterns labeled seasonal only if recurring in both fiscal years; one-year swings listed in appendix.

Channels do different jobs by design

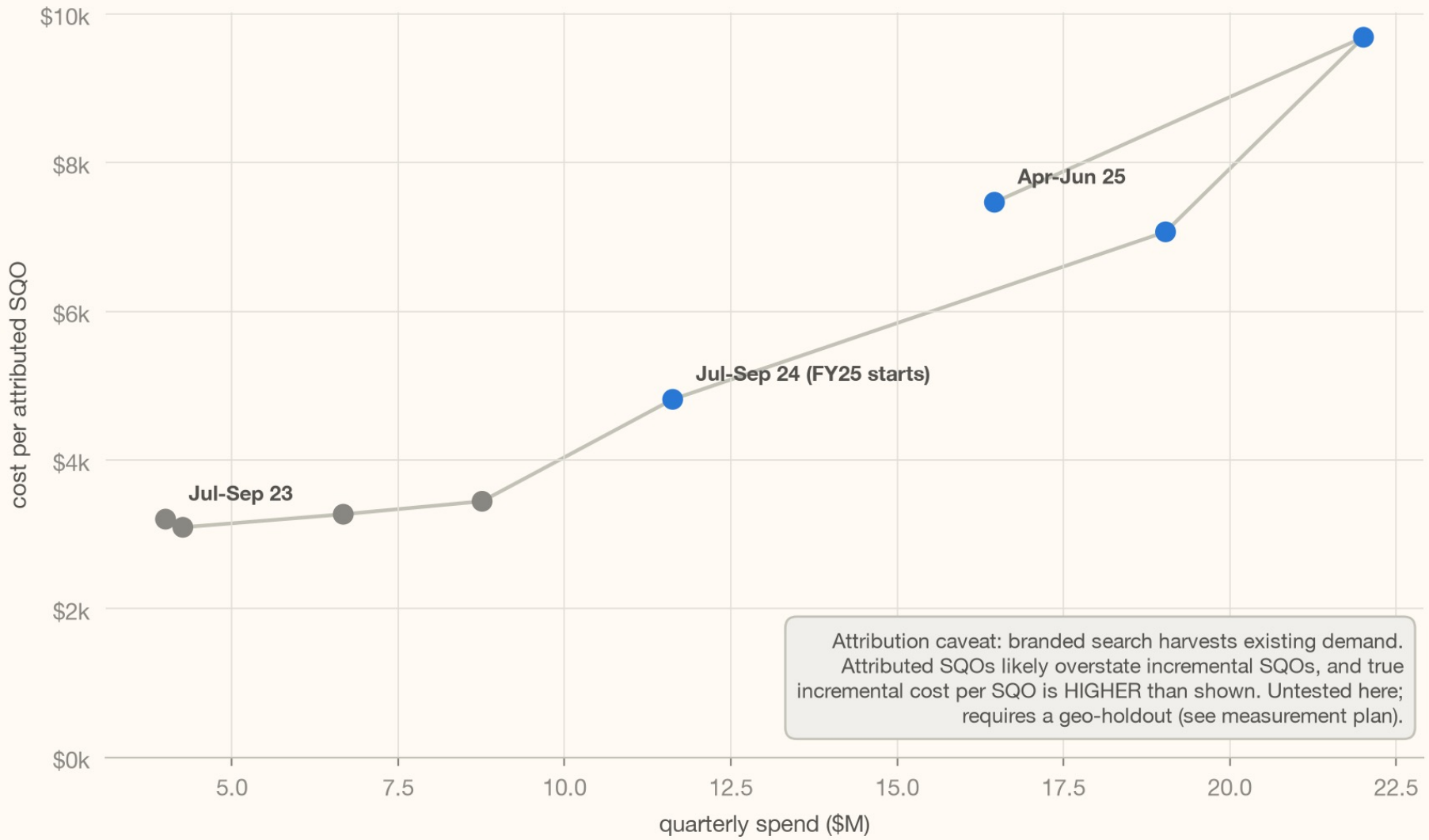
social broadcasts, search captures, brand search converts — FY25 funnel shapes differ by an order of magnitude

	paid_social	paid_search	paid_brand_search
impression → click	0.37%	2.79%	8.85%
click → demo	0.03%	0.23%	0.74%
demo → SQO	34.5%	38.9%	57.3%
SQO per 1,000 clicks	0.1	0.9	4.2
cost per SQO	$26,826	$10,609	$7,213

FY25 (Jul-24–Jun-25); ratios of fiscal-year totals on attributed values, volume-weighted; funnel-lag caveat.

Efficiency fell as spend scaled — brand search cost/SQO doubled on ~3× budget

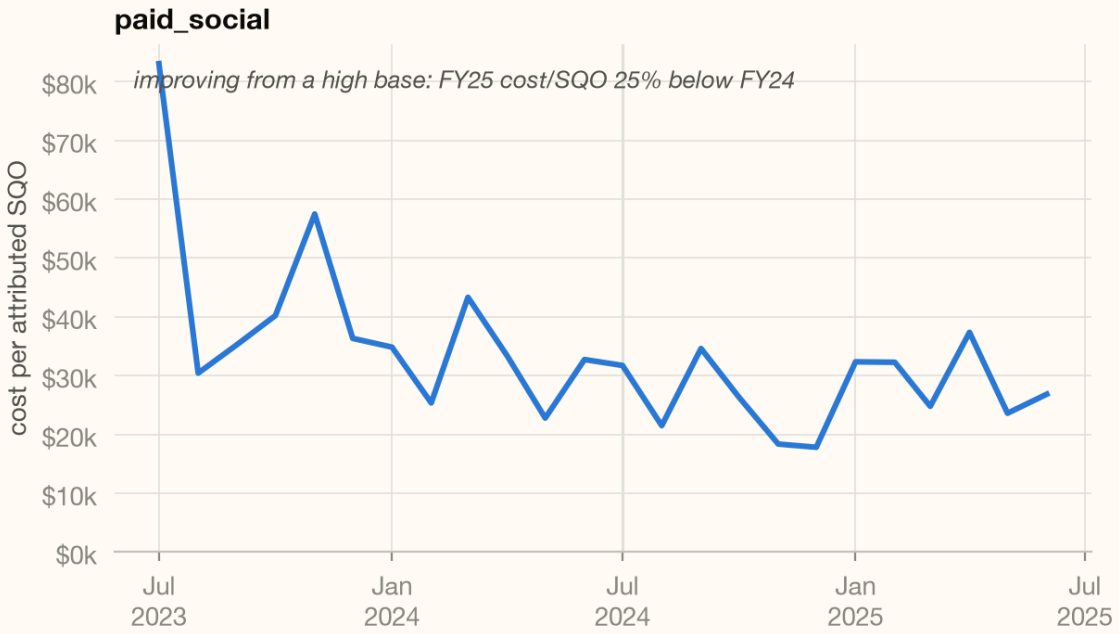
although expected, that's undesirable and where optimization opportunities live

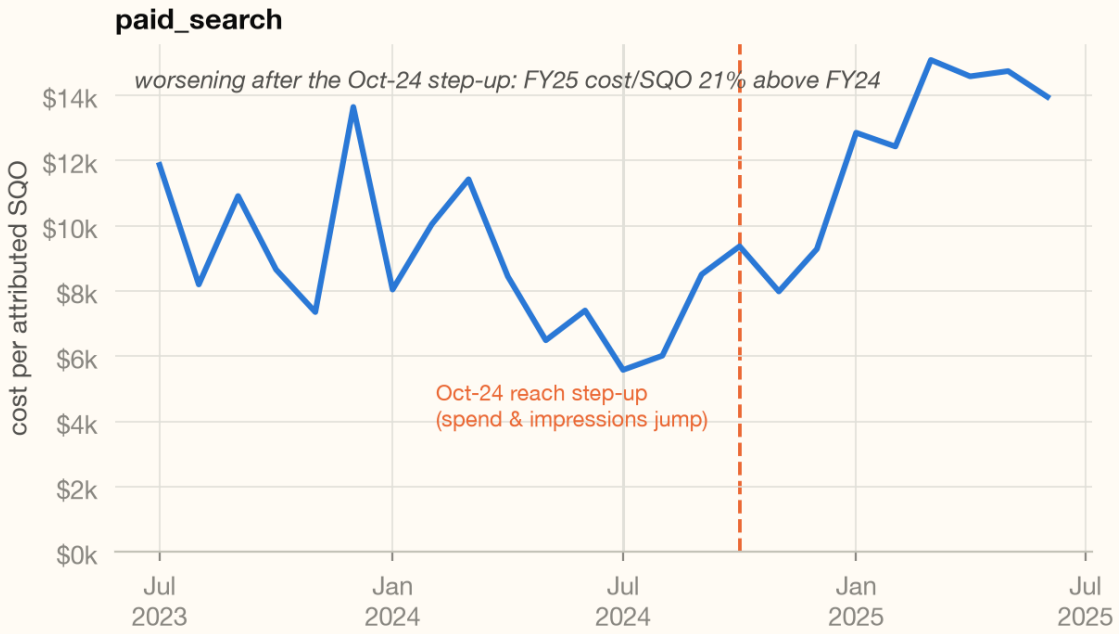


- paid search's Oct-24 reach step-up: ~$32k of marginal spend per added SQO, ~4× its prior average
- higher-spend months coincide with worse cost/SQO in both channels

Paid Search's Oct-24 ramp up

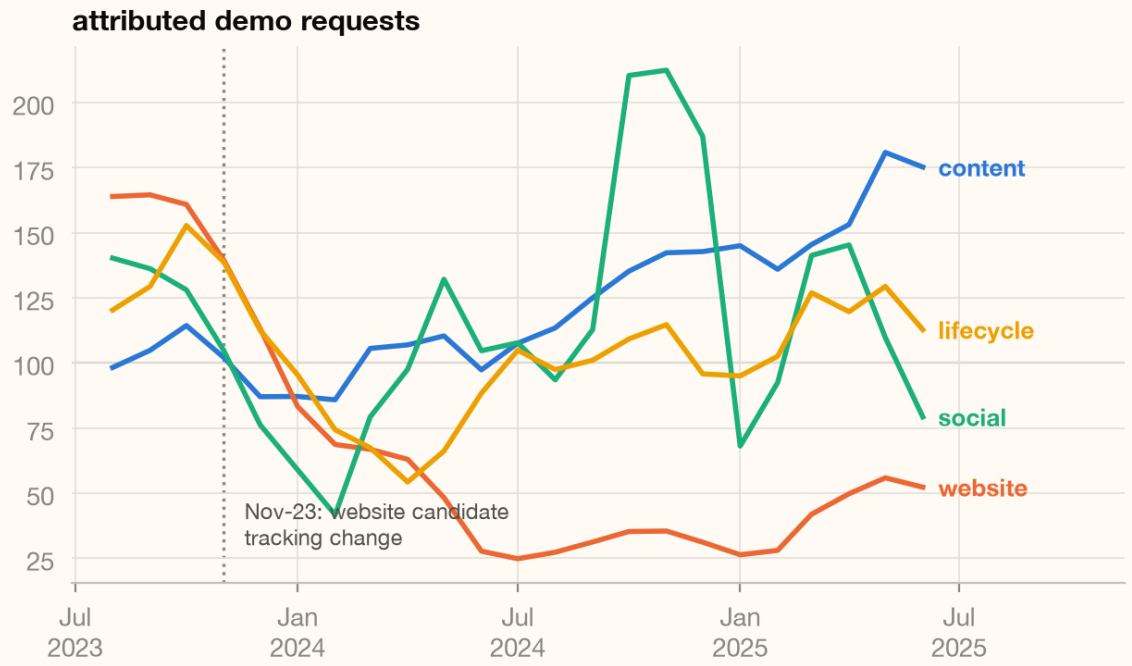
~$32k of marginal spend per added SQO, which is substantially (~4x) higher than its prior average

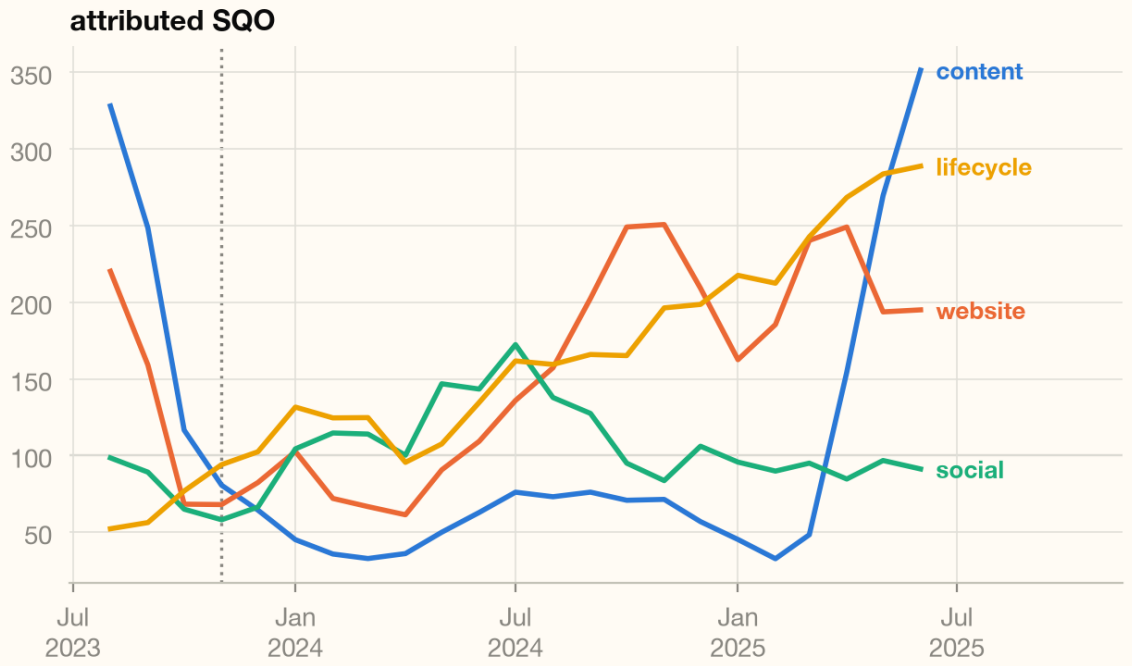




- charts show monthly average cost per attributed SQO; the ~$32k headline is the marginal cost of the step-up (Δ spend ÷ Δ added SQOs) computed, not plotted on any line
- Paid search's average rose ~$7.9k → ~$12.1k across the step-up; the marginal dollar deteriorated fastest
- disclaimer: arithmetic association, not incrementality

Zero-cost brand & organic channels grew while paid efficiency fell





- lifecycle attributed SQOs +114% YoY
- zero-media-cost channels hold 13.6% of FY25's attributed SQOs under a model that undercounts demand creation

Next Steps

Incrementality Measurement + Budgeting Process + Tracking Cleanup

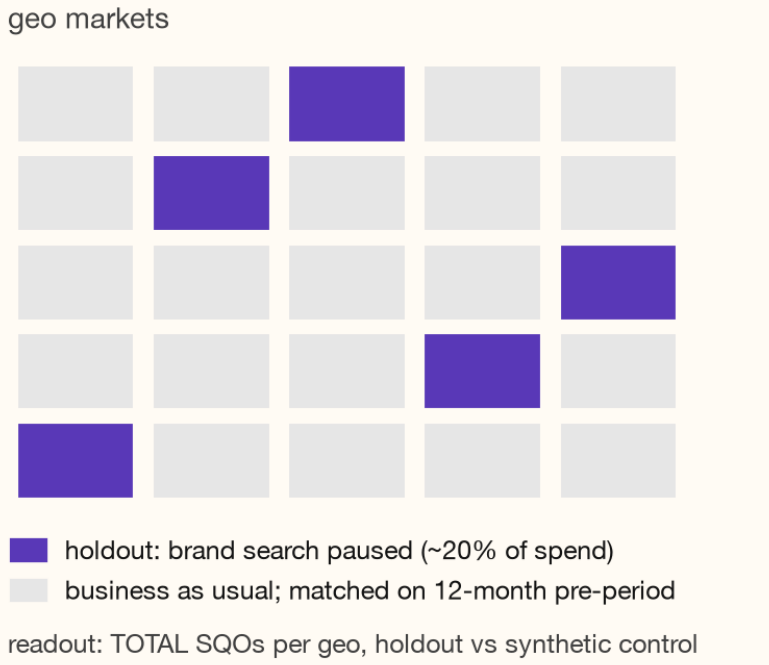
Measuring what's actually incremental through experimentation

brand search's efficiency is the least trustworthy number here (demand harvesting + the largest win-rate jump); MTA-based credit likely understates the zero-cost channels that create the demand it captures

Geo-holdout: pricing brand search incrementality

Pause paid_brand_search in matched geo markets covering ~20% of spend

- 12 weeks (2-week burn-in — assumed click→SQO lag, validated in-flight; 10-week read; 12-month pre-period for matching)
- Primary metric: TOTAL SQOs per geo — never attributed SQOs; an attribution model cannot audit itself
- Readout: matched-market / synthetic-control estimate (CausalImpact-style)
- Decision rule:
  - incremental cost/SQO > 2× the attributed $7.2k → cap and reallocate
  - below → scale with confidence
- Sized to separate “mostly incremental” from “mostly harvested”, not to estimate precise lift



illustrative design, not data

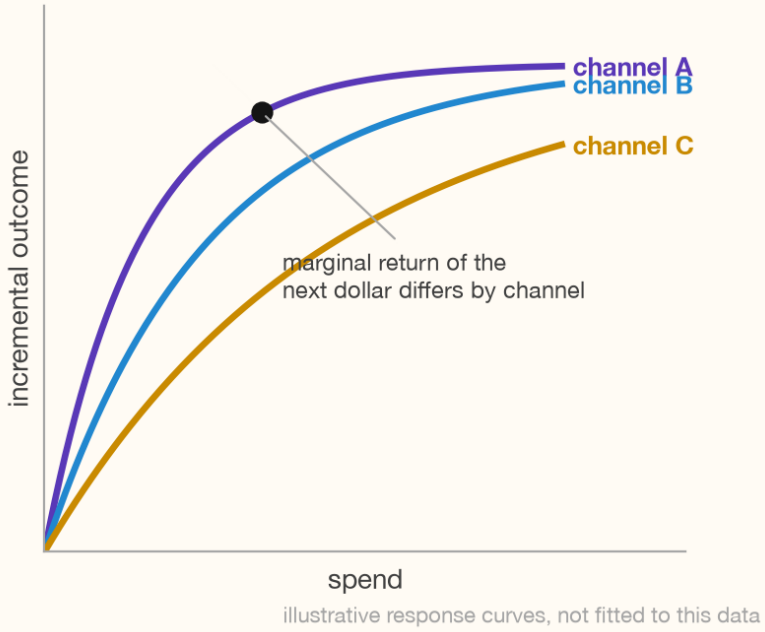
MMM prices the marginal dollar; experiments keep it honest

Attribution assigns credit to touchpoints but is not the right tool to find the marginal dollar per channel. Experiments answer single questions precisely while MMM generalizes them

MMM Prices the marginal dollar per channel

Start with a one-off MMM, then make it a permanent monthly budget-allocation tool:

- Provides budget-allocation insights through the capture of media saturation and cross-channel effects while having robustness to tracking loss & attribution model changes
- Inputs exist today with two full years of daily spend and outcomes
    - plumbing the data is, nevertheless, usually challenging
- Expect wide intervals at this program count — MMM for direction, experiments for the price
    - holdout results calibrate the model rather than compete with it
- Once properly set up it can be used on a monthly-basis for simulating the likely effects of changes in the budget, promotions or channel mix



Historical trends aren't trustworthy until these tracking debts are cleared

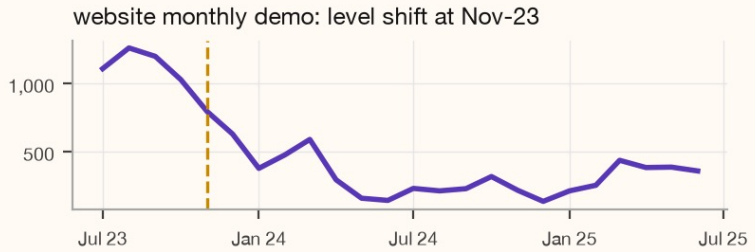
because a good analysis starts with trustworthy data

Garbage in, garbage out

Having the historical data right (or having a documented explanation on why it isn’t) is a fundamental part of the roadmap.

- MQP capture starts Feb-24 so it is necessary to have documented definitions and backfill or fence historical reporting.
- Website demo definition shifted Nov-23 and reconciliation must happen before any trend crossing that date is trusted.
- Enforcing daily-grain delivery contracts on vendor click batch-dumps (e.g. abm, sponsorship)
- Define metrics in the semantic layer (dbt/Looker) and version tracking history, so future reporting inherits definitions instead of rediscovering these bugs







real series from clean_daily.csv

Stakeholder recommendations

Paid Marketing Director

- Search and brand search hold 81% of FY25's growth in attributed “Wins”
- The risk is rising marginal cost
  - brand search cost/SQO doubled on ~3× spend
  - Oct-24 reach expansion bought SQOs at ~4× the prior rate
  - the holdout test (potentially funded by budget holds) shows within a quarter which spend is incremental.
- Until the roadmap rollout:
  - reduce paid search back to pre-Oct-24
  - hold brand search
  - hold paid social
- In 2–3 months:
  - test live, first readout, marginal-cost view in the pacing dashboards.

Head of Marketing

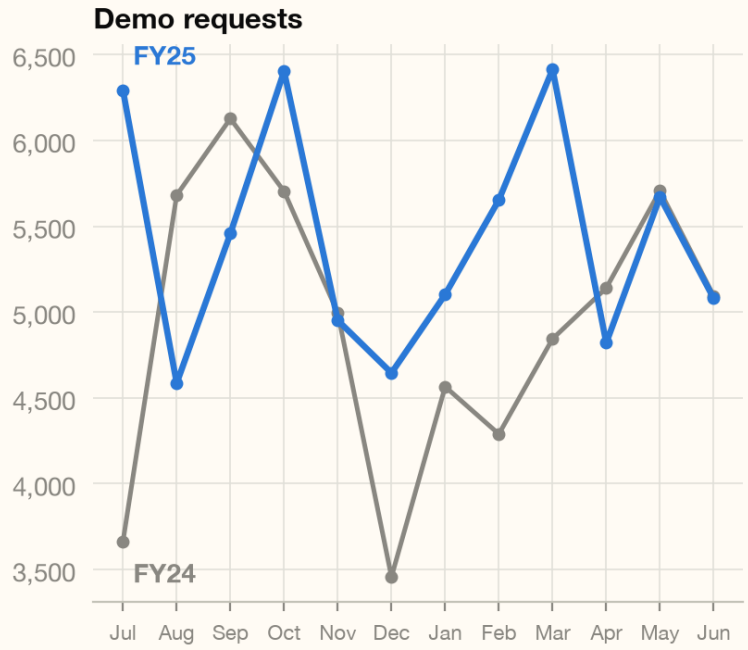
- Zero-media-cost channels hold 13.6% of attributed SQOs and lifecycle +114%
  - under a model that structurally undercounts demand creation.
- If brand search harvests, your channels create what it captures.
- The measurement plan shines a light on that:
  - leading indicators (branded search volume, direct traffic, unattributed demos) within weeks
  - geo-lift on any brand increase
  - MMM for the full picture.
  - In 2–3 months there will be a live baseline

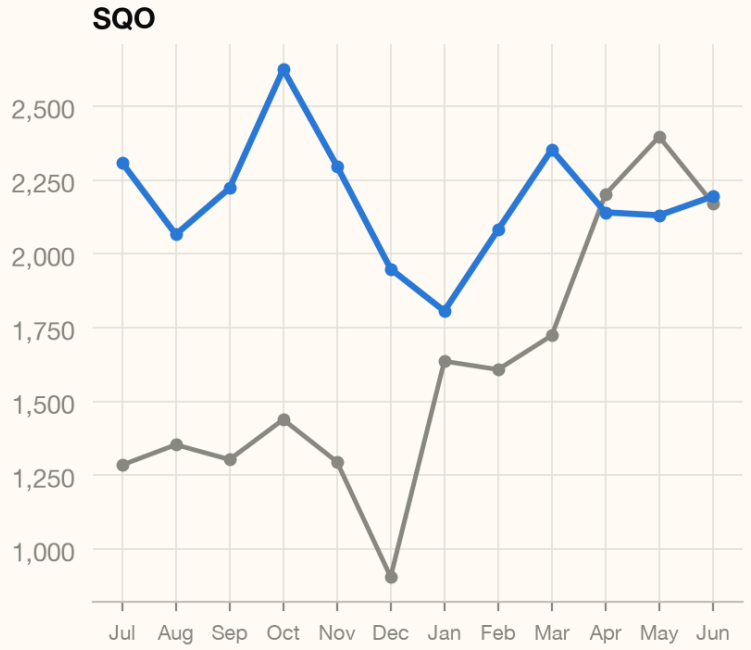
Thank you

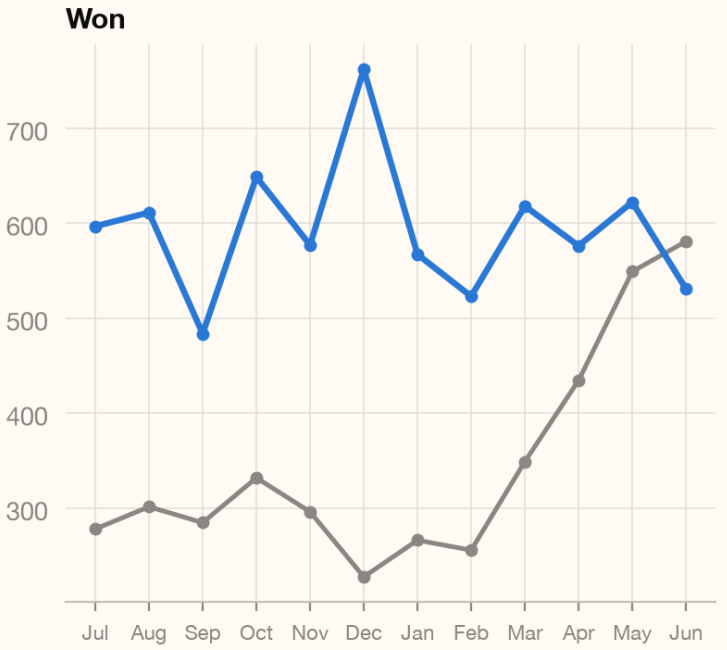
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APPENDIX

FY24 vs FY25 by fiscal month: demo requests, SQO, won

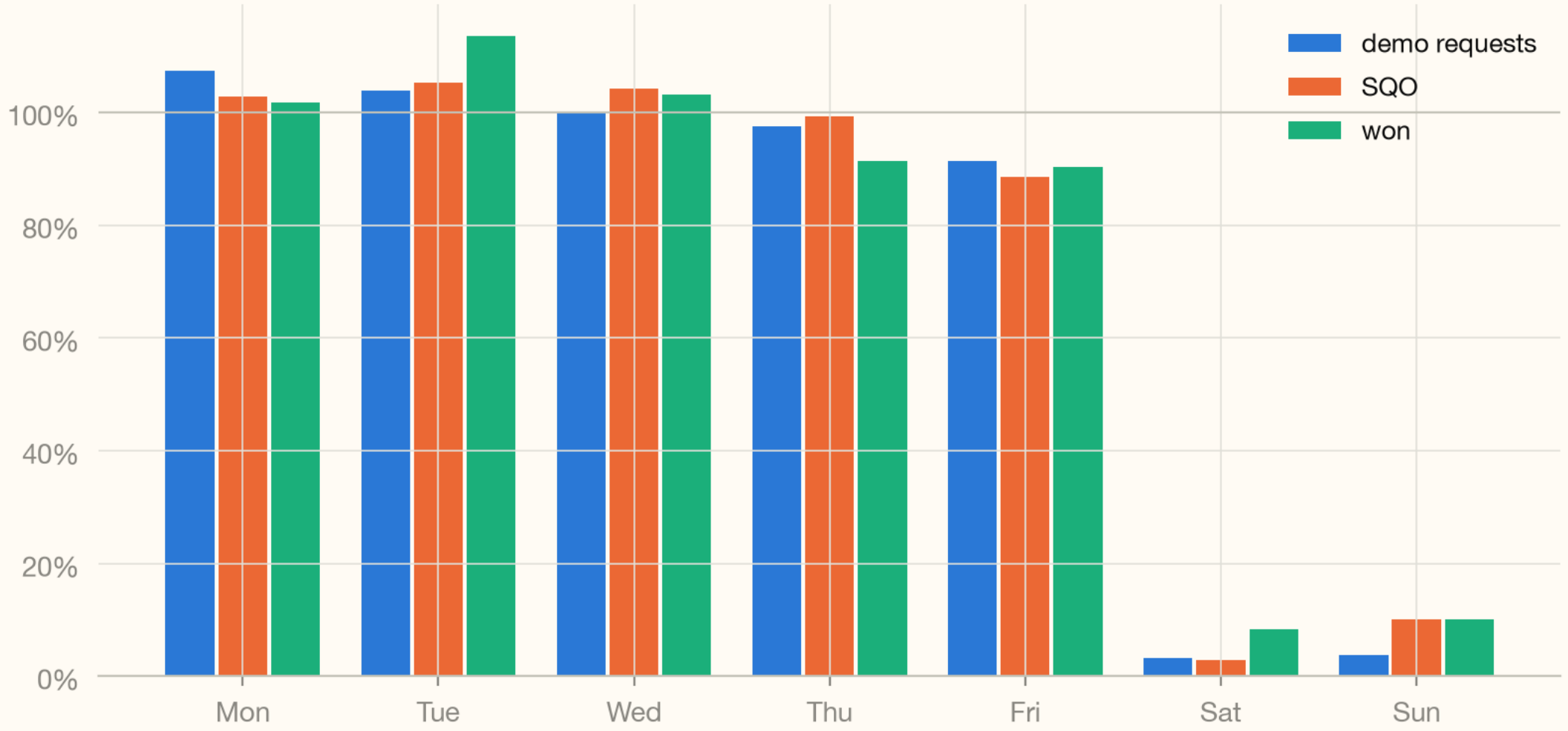






APPENDIX

Day-of-week profile: mean daily volume as % of the Mon–Fri average



APPENDIX

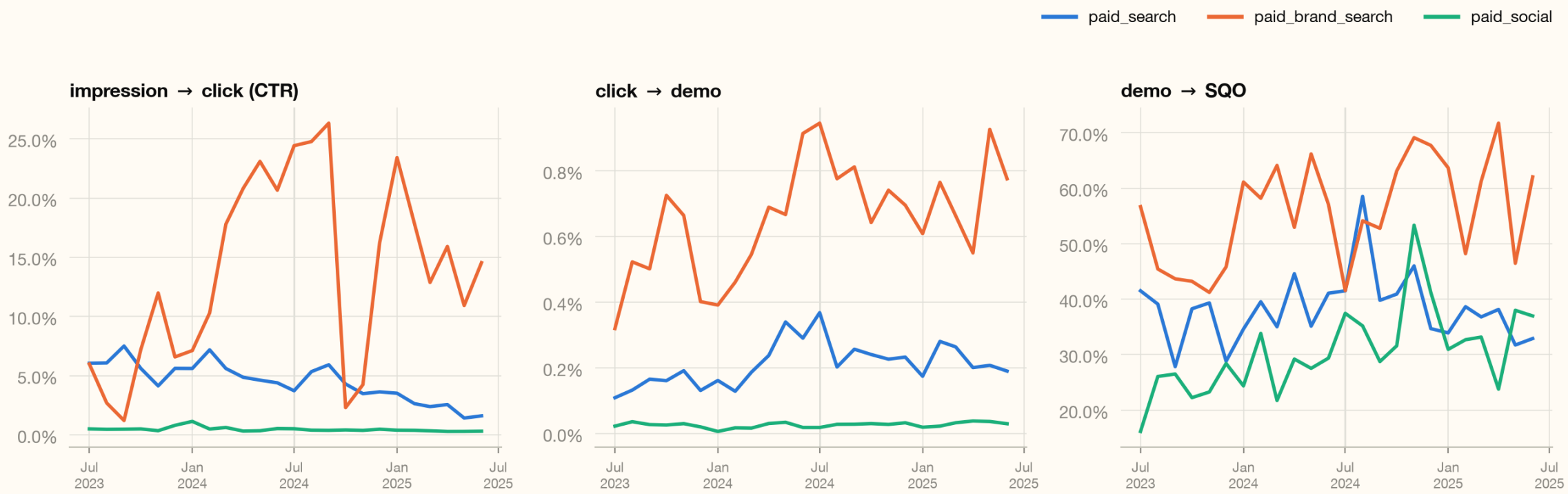
Seasonal patterns vs one-year swings: the both-years rule applied

December dip	**recurring seasonal**	demo −30%/−14%, SQO −44%/−11% vs centered rolling mean, both years
October lift	**recurring seasonal**	demo +18%/+18%, won +10%/+12%, both years
January restart dip	**recurring seasonal**	prospects −23%/−40%, demo −9%/−6%, both years
May–June prospects lift	**recurring seasonal**	May +28%/+6%, Jun +17%/+26%, both years
Jan-24 paid_social delivery burst	**one-off event**	impressions 5.3× and clicks 7.5× vs Dec-23 on cost +94%; CTR 2–3× norm
Jul-24 event burst	**one-off event**	prospects +40% vs rolling mean; single-day event MQP spike 957× median
Dec-24 Won spike	**one-off event**	+29% vs rolling mean; Dec-23 was −34%, failing the both-years rule
paid_awareness Mar-25 ramp	**one-off event (flight)**	monthly spend ~$133k → ~$1.1M from Mar-25; program is flighted by design

Seasonal = same-direction deviation from a centered 12-month rolling mean in BOTH fiscal years (|dev| > 5%). Full 16-row table with hypotheses and confirming evidence: task 1 notebook. Tracking artifacts (MQP start, website Nov-23, click dumps): slide 11.

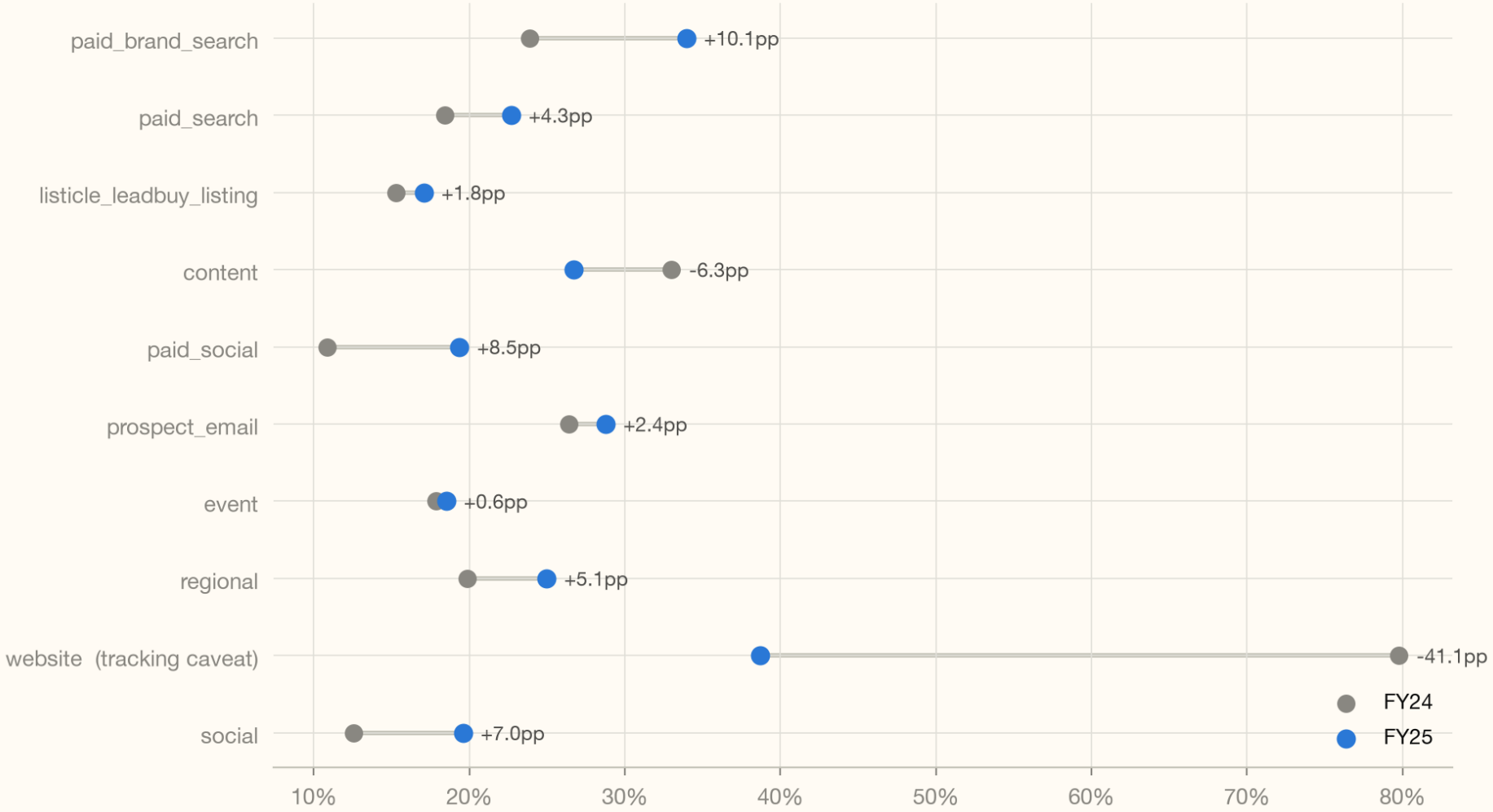
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Channel rate trends: CTR, click→demo, demo→SQO (monthly)



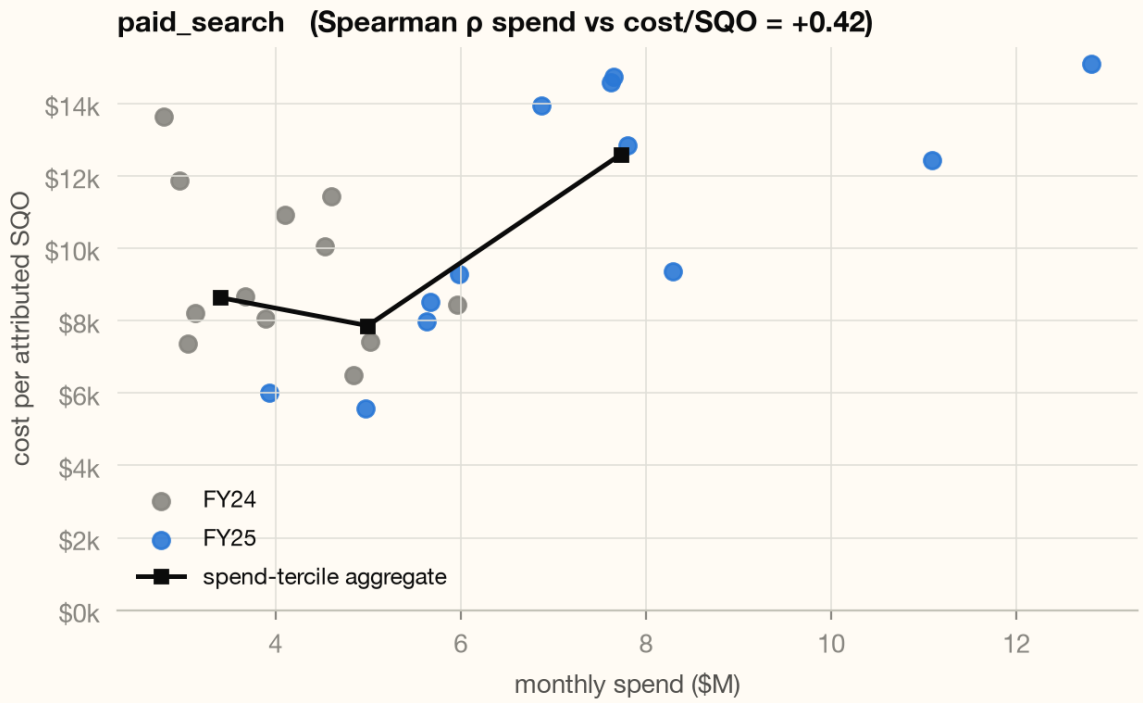
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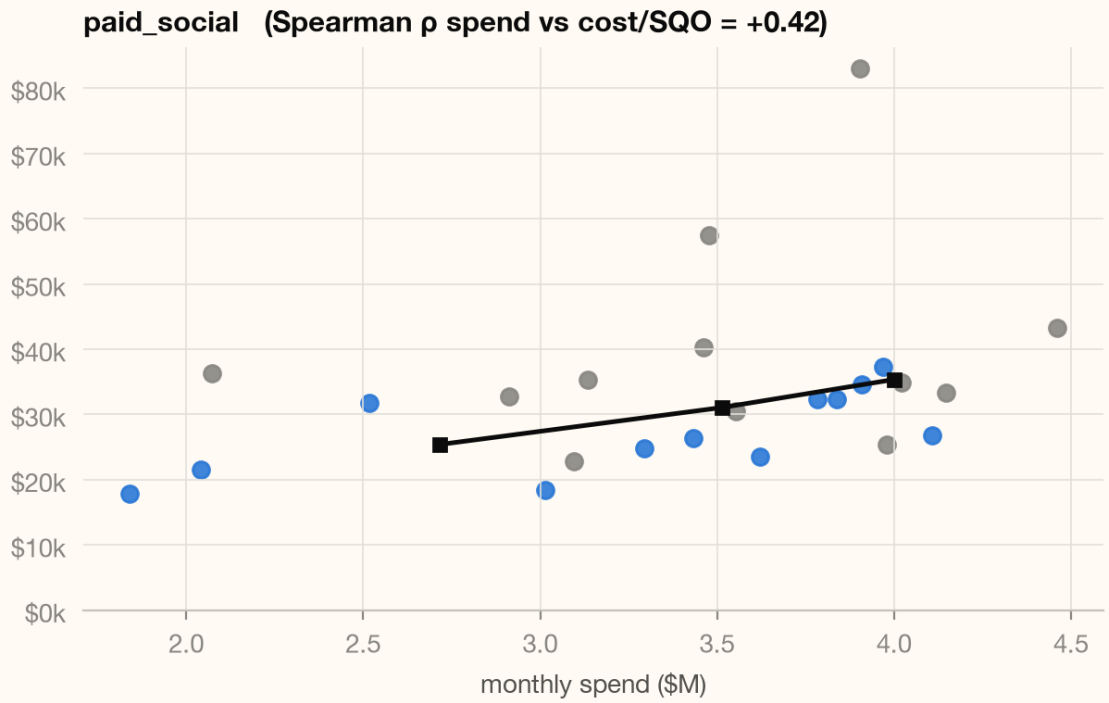
SQO→Won by program: FY24 vs FY25 (≥100 attributed SQO in both years)



APPENDIX

Monthly spend vs cost per attributed SQO: points + spend-tercile aggregates

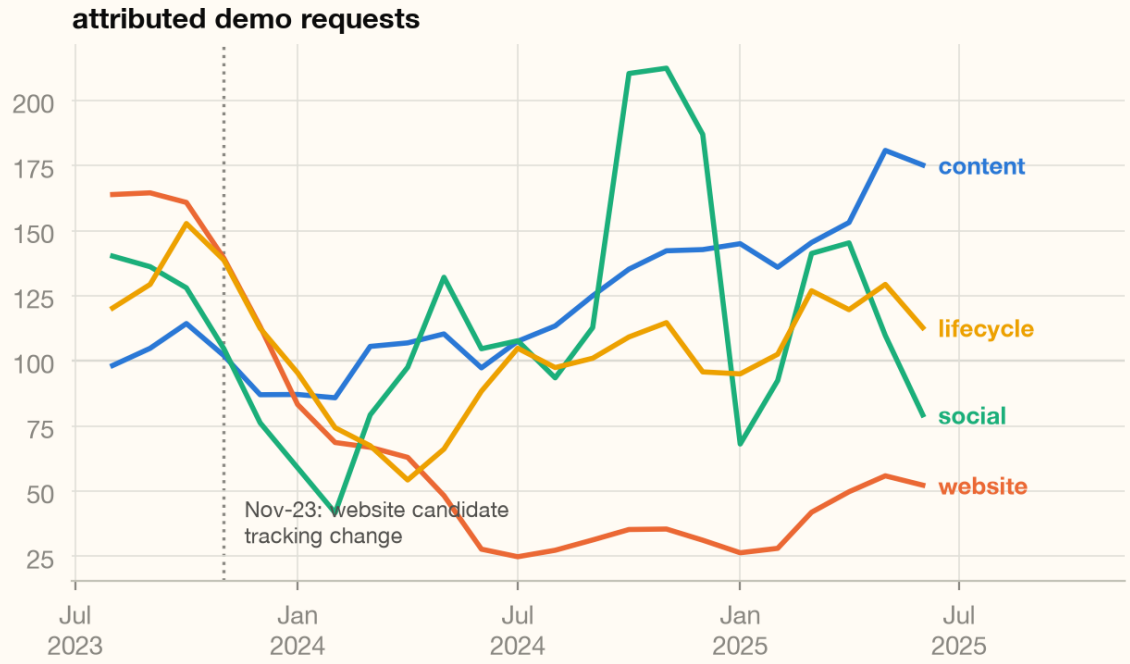


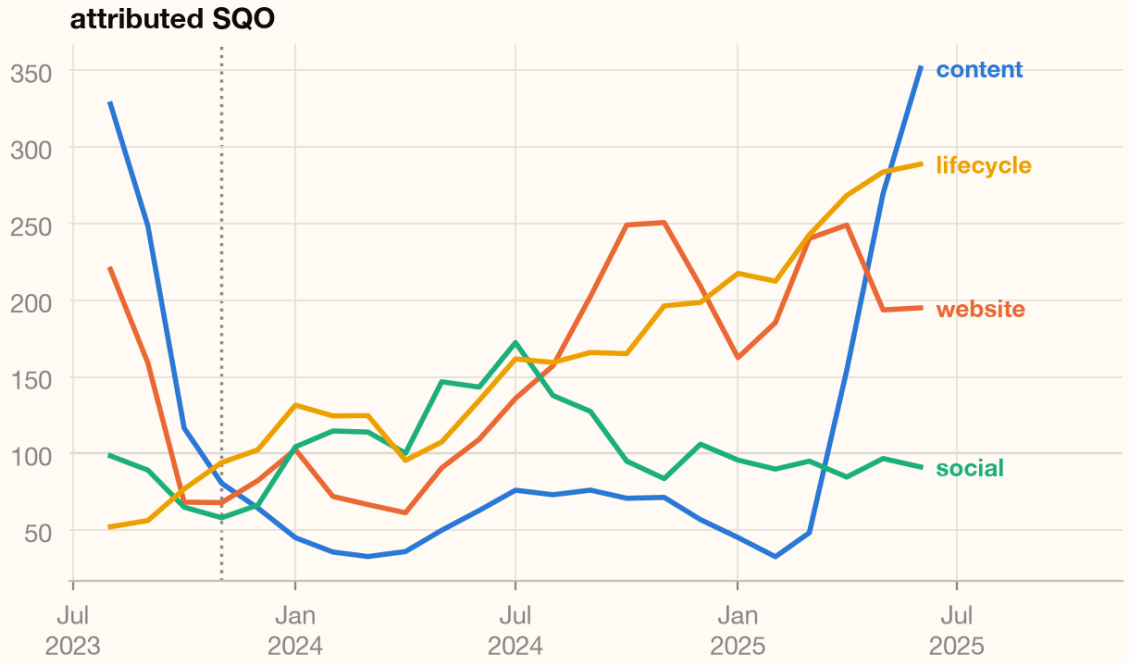


Association under scaling, not a causal response curve; seasonality, mix and auction conditions unmodeled.

APPENDIX

Brand/organic attributed demo & SQO, indexed to FY24 average = 100; website carries the Nov-23 tracking caveat





APPENDIX

Methodology & caveats

- Attribution: SQO / Won are fractional multi-touch attributed credit, used as-is, phrased as attributed values, never as deals counted once.

- Funnel lag: stages are not same-day cohorts (MQP > Prospects in ~13% of daily rows, Demo > MQP in ~29%). All rates at monthly grain or coarser; period ratios, not cohort rates.

- MQP tracking starts Feb-24 (effectively zero before: one 2-unit row in Jan-24); analyzed from Mar-24 only, FY YoY suppressed. Detail: slide 12.

- website demo definition shift Nov-23 (candidate tracking change, hypothesis). Detail: slide 12.

- De-duplication: 52 duplicate (date, program) rows (26 keys, regional & website, Jun-18..30 2025; one real + one all-zero row each) aggregated by sum; the all-zero rows also carried a wrong team label, repaired to the program's majority team.

- ooh & paid_other excluded (zero cost, zero outcomes); 35 clicks>impressions rows flagged and excluded from CTR only.

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every assumption & cleaning decision: ASSUMPTIONS.md · reproduce end-to-end: ./run.sh (raw CSV → clean data → figures → this deck). All 75 headline numbers re-derived from the raw file in analysis/verify_numbers.py.